EDCOM II YO3 REPORT

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The EDCOM 2 Year 3 Report, also called "Turning Point," is an important document about education in the Philippines. After learning about this report, I feel both worried and hopeful. The report tells the truth about our education system. Some of the truth is hard to accept, but I believe knowing the truth is the first step to making things better.

The biggest problem the report shows is that students are not learning enough. Only 0.47 percent of Grade 12 students are proficient in their skills. This means that out of 1,000 students, only 4 or 5 can do what is expected for their grade level. This is a very low number. The report also says that by Grade 3, only 30 percent of students are proficient. But as students move to higher grades, this number goes down instead of up. The report calls this a "proficiency collapse." This made me realize that our education system is not working well.

The report explains three main reasons for this problem. First, many young children are not healthy. About 23.6 percent of children under five years old are stunted, meaning they do not get enough good food. This hurts their brain development before they even start school. Second, teachers are forced to pass students who are not ready. This is called "mass promotion." Teachers feel pressure from school leaders to pass everyone, so weak students keep moving up without learning the basics. Third, the education system did not focus on the most important things for many years. Reading, math, and good nutrition for small children were not prioritized.

But the report does not only show problems. It also gives a solution. The report created a 10-year plan called the NatPlan 2026-2035. This plan says we must fix the foundations first. That means focusing on children from zero to four years old, making sure they are healthy. It also means making sure every child can read by Grade 3. The plan asks for consistent reforms that will not change every time a new president or new Congress takes office. This is very important. If we change the plan every few years, nothing will get better.

In conclusion, the EDCOM 2 Year 3 Report is a wake-up call for our country. The numbers are sad, and the problems are big. But I am hopeful because now we know exactly what is wrong and what needs to be done. The government has also given a bigger budget for education. The real challenge is to follow the plan for 10 years without giving up. We cannot fix 30 years of problems in one year. But if we start now and stay focused, maybe in the future, more than 0.47 percent of our students will be ready for life and work. That is a future worth working for.